Dubai Farms Programme

Knowledge base compiled from official and news sources

Compiled: 7 Oct 2026 | **Topic:** Dubai Farms programme run by Dubai Municipality, supporting Emirati farmers in the Emirate of Dubai, UAE

How to use this document

This document gathers what is publicly stated about the Dubai Farms programme across five sources. Each source starts on its own page with its URL and date, followed by a summary, key facts and question-and-answer pairs. The text is a restatement in plain language, so facts, figures, names and dates follow the sources. Where a figure or date appears only in one source, the section says which one. Part 7 lists what the sources do not cover.

Programme at a glance

Name	Dubai Farms (also written 'The Dubai Farms programme')
What it is	A programme of services and incentives that supports productive Emirati farmers and aims to make Dubai's agriculture sector more productive and sustainable.
Run by	Dubai Municipality
Launched by	His Highness Sheikh Hamdan bin Mohammed bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai and Chairman of the Executive Council of Dubai
Announced	4 March 2024 (announcement posted by Sheikh Hamdan on X and LinkedIn; news coverage dated 5 March 2024)
Target group	Emirati farmers who own productive agricultural projects
Core services	Farming consultation; subsidised farming supplies; required lab testing; pest control; guidance on meeting local market needs; contracting with a specialised crop distributor
Other incentives	Competitive prices for farming supplies, machinery and irrigation systems
Events and initiatives	Plant Your Food (house gardening), Hatta Farming Festival, seasonal farmers' market events
Policy alignment	Dubai Social Agenda 33; Dubai Food Security Strategy; national 'Grow UAE' programme (as referenced in Dubai Municipality statements)

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Part 1 - Official UAE Government Portal page

Source: The Official Platform of the UAE Government (u.ae), Environment and energy section

URL: https://u.ae/en/about-the-uae/strategies-initiatives-and-awards/strategies-plans-and-visions/environment-and-energy/the-dubai-farms-programme

Published / updated: Page updated 30 Dec 2024

Retrieved: 7 Oct 2026

Summary

The u.ae page describes the Dubai Farms programme as a set of services and incentives for Emirati farmers who own productive agricultural projects. Through Dubai Municipality the programme provides farming consultation services, subsidised farming supplies, the lab testing that farmers need, and pest control services. It also directs farmers toward what the local market needs and contracts with a specialised distributor of crops.

Further incentives are competitive prices for farming supplies, machinery and irrigation systems. The programme also organises the Plant Your Food initiative, which encourages house gardening, plus the Hatta Farming Festival and other seasonal farmers' market events. The page links to a WAM (Emirates News Agency) article on the launch.

Key facts

- Beneficiaries: Emirati farmers who own productive agricultural projects.
- Delivered through: Dubai Municipality.
- Services: consultation, subsidised supplies, lab testing, pest control, market guidance, contracting with a crop distributor.
- Incentives: competitive prices on supplies, machinery and irrigation systems.
- Initiatives: Plant Your Food (house gardening); Hatta Farming Festival; seasonal farmers' markets.
- Location on u.ae: About the UAE > Strategies, policies, initiatives and awards > Strategies and visions > Environment and energy.

Questions and answers

Q: What is the Dubai Farms programme?
A: A programme of services and incentives that supports Emirati farmers who own productive agricultural projects, delivered through Dubai Municipality.

Q: Who can benefit from the Dubai Farms programme?
A: Emirati farmers who own productive agricultural projects.

Q: What services does Dubai Municipality provide under the programme?
A: Farming consultation services, subsidised farming supplies, required lab testing, pest control services, guidance toward local market needs, and contracting with a specialised crop distributor.

Q: Does the programme help with the cost of farming equipment?
A: Yes. It offers competitive prices for farming supplies, machinery and irrigation systems.

Q: What is Plant Your Food?
A: An initiative under the Dubai Farms programme that encourages house gardening.

Q: Which events belong to the programme?
A: The Hatta Farming Festival and other seasonal farmers' market events, plus the Plant Your Food initiative.

Part 2 - Launch announcement and aims

Source: ARN News Centre, 'H.H. Sheikh Hamdan launches Dubai Farms initiative'

URL: https://www.arnnewscentre.ae/news/uae/h-h-sheikh-hamdan-launches-dubai-farms-initiative/

Published / updated: Tuesday 5 March 2024

Retrieved: 7 Oct 2026

Note: The same announcement appears in a post by Sheikh Hamdan on LinkedIn and X dated 4 March 2024.

Summary

Sheikh Hamdan bin Mohammed bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai and Chairman of the Executive Council, launched the Dubai Farms programme to support Emirati farmers. Dubai Municipality runs it. The coverage says it will help subsidise farming supplies and provide farming consultation and pest control services, among other offerings.

In his announcement, Sheikh Hamdan said the programme gives productive Emirati farmers a full suite of incentives and services. These are meant to develop the emirate's agriculture sector, make crops more sustainable, and increase agriculture's contribution to the emirate's GDP. He added that the effort to make Dubai's agriculture more productive and sustainable would continue.

Why the programme exists

Sheikh Hamdan stressed the importance of local agriculture in Dubai and the need to develop and sustain it. He linked this to Sheikh Mohammed bin Rashid Al Maktoum's vision of making Dubai the world's best city in which to live and work. In his LinkedIn post he called it a strategic endeavour to strengthen the agricultural sector, a milestone in the commitment to sustainable agriculture, and part of improving citizens' quality of life and securing a prosperous future for coming generations.

Link to Dubai Social Agenda 33

The programme aligns with the Dubai Social Agenda 33, launched by Sheikh Mohammed bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai. The agenda aims to make Dubai the premier city for living experiences, empower its citizens, increase their contribution to the emirate's economy, and ensure their financial independence and social stability.

Key facts

- Launched by: Sheikh Hamdan bin Mohammed bin Rashid Al Maktoum (announced 4 March 2024).
- Managed by: Dubai Municipality.
- Stated goals: develop Dubai's agriculture sector, make crops more sustainable, raise agriculture's contribution to GDP.

- Policy link: Dubai Social Agenda 33; vision of Sheikh Mohammed bin Rashid for Dubai as the best city to live and work.

Questions and answers

Q: Who launched the Dubai Farms programme?
A: Sheikh Hamdan bin Mohammed bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai and Chairman of the Executive Council.

Q: When was Dubai Farms launched?
A: It was announced on 4 March 2024; news coverage followed on 5 March 2024.

Q: Which body runs the programme?
A: Dubai Municipality.

Q: What are the stated aims?
A: To support productive Emirati farmers with incentives and services, develop the emirate's agriculture sector, enhance crop sustainability, and increase agriculture's contribution to the emirate's GDP.

Q: How does Dubai Farms connect to Dubai Social Agenda 33?
A: The programme aligns with the agenda's objectives of making Dubai the premier city for living experiences, empowering citizens, raising their contribution to the economy, and securing their financial independence and social stability.

Part 3 - Second Hatta Farming Festival (January 2025)

Source: Dubai Municipality, 'Hatta Farming Festival returns to promote agriculture and agri-tourism'

URL: https://www.dm.gov.ae/hatta-farming-festival-returns-to-promote-agriculture-and-agri-tourism-support-investors-sustainable-agriculture/

Published / updated: 18 January 2025

Retrieved: 7 Oct 2026

Summary

Dubai Municipality launched the second Hatta Farming Festival as part of the Dubai Farms programme. The festival sits under the Hatta Winter initiative. It opened on 18 January 2025 at Leem Lake in Hatta and ran until 22 January. It brought together 25 Emirati farmers, homesteaders and local agricultural companies, along with investors and specialists from the public and private sectors.

The festival aims to promote agri-tourism in Hatta, show tourist farms, and encourage collaboration. It supports the Hatta Comprehensive Development Plan and the initiatives of the Supreme Committee to Oversee the Development of Hatta, and it offers a platform for agricultural guidance and knowledge sharing.

Support delivered to Hatta farmers in 2024

Fertilisers	24,550 bags of organic and chemical fertilisers
Seeds	2,440 bags
Pest control	1,350 light and pheromone traps
Field visits	More than 1,250
Training courses	12
Agricultural forums	4
Tourist farm	The Strawberry Model Farm, described as the region's first tourist farm and a showcase for sustainable farming

What the festival offered

- Exhibitions of agricultural and livestock products from Hatta farms.
- Educational workshops and dialogue sessions with agricultural experts.
- Public livestock auctions and awards for outstanding farmers.
- Sessions on success stories, young farm owners and entrepreneurship in modern agriculture.
- A free agricultural extension platform giving farmers guidance and information.

- The Dubai Smart Mobile Laboratory, which tests vegetables, fruits, groundwater and irrigation.
- A mobile public health service for veterinary consultations and Brucella antibody detection for participating farm owners.

What officials said

Her Excellency Dr. Amna bint Abdullah Al Dhahak, Minister of Climate Change and Environment, linked the festival to the UAE's drive for sustainable national food security, more local production of strategic crops and less reliance on food imports. She mentioned the Plant the Emirates National Programme and the National Agriculture Centre, and said the festival fits the agenda of Dubai Farms.

His Excellency Eng. Marwan bin Ghalita, Acting Director General of Dubai Municipality, called the festival central to Dubai Farms and said the programme complements the national 'Grow UAE' programme. He said the aim is to help Emirati farmers become self-sufficient, contribute to Dubai's food security strategy and improve quality of life.

Questions and answers

Q: When and where was the second Hatta Farming Festival held?
A: It opened on 18 January 2025 at Leem Lake in Hatta and ran until 22 January 2025.

Q: How many farmers took part in the second festival?
A: 25 Emirati farmers, homesteaders and local agricultural companies took part, together with investors and specialists.

Q: What support did Hatta farmers receive in 2024?
A: 24,550 bags of fertilisers, 2,440 bags of seeds, 1,350 light and pheromone traps, over 1,250 field visits, 12 training courses and four agricultural forums.

Q: What is the Strawberry Model Farm?
A: The first tourist farm established in the Hatta region, serving as a showcase for sustainable farming practices.

Q: What testing services were available at the festival?
A: The Dubai Smart Mobile Laboratory tested vegetables, fruits, groundwater and irrigation, and a mobile public health service offered veterinary consultations and Brucella antibody detection.

Part 4 - Third Hatta Farming Festival (January 2026)

Source: Dubai Municipality, 'Dubai Municipality announces the 3rd Hatta Farming Festival'
URL: https://www.dm.gov.ae/dubai-municipality-announces-the-3rd-hatta-farming-festival/
Published / updated: 27 January 2026 (press release dated 28 January 2026)
Retrieved: 7 Oct 2026

Summary

Dubai Municipality announced the third edition of the Hatta Farming Festival as part of the Dubai Farms programme. The festival ran until 1 February 2026 at Hatta Leem Lake. It featured Emirati farmers, estate owners and local agricultural companies, and it forms part of the Hatta Winter initiative launched by Brand Dubai, the creative arm of the Government of Dubai Media Office. It is organised under the supervision of the Supreme Committee to Oversee the Development of Hatta and contributes to the #DubaiDestinations campaign.

What was new in the third edition

- Larger scale than earlier years, with more specialised farms and estates and more companies showing modern farming solutions.
- For the first time, comprehensive participation from government entities and the private sector to support and empower People of Determination, including product displays and workshops.
- Free public access.

Support packages for Hatta farmers

Total value	AED 3.7 million in strengthened support packages for the agricultural sector in Hatta
Fertilisers	24,675 bags of organic and chemical fertilisers distributed
Seeds	5,170 bags of seed varieties distributed
Services	Agricultural extension and pest control services under Municipality supervision
Projects	Three tourism and production projects supported by modern agricultural technologies

Programme and registration

The festival offered platforms for showcasing and selling locally produced agricultural and family products, as well as dedicated platforms for Dubai Central Laboratory and veterinary services. The programme included a livestock beauty and quality contest, training and guidance, consultancy for farmers, and competitions and prizes for farmers, farms and visitors. Registration was open to Hatta residents free of charge, and participants were exempt from permit fees for temporary food-related activities during the event.

What the Director General said

H.E. Marwan Ahmed bin Ghalita, Director General of Dubai Municipality, described the festival as a strategic platform that brings organised-market access, training and advisory services together in one place. He said this raises the efficiency of Emirati farmers, improves product quality, strengthens farm sustainability, and contributes to Dubai's food security ecosystem. He added that it supports the adoption of modern, environmentally responsible practices, diversifies the local economy and strengthens Hatta's position as an agri-tourism and eco-tourism destination.

Questions and answers

Q: When was the third Hatta Farming Festival held?
A: It was announced on 27-28 January 2026 and ran until 1 February 2026 at Hatta Leem Lake.

Q: How much were the Hatta support packages worth?
A: AED 3.7 million.

Q: How many bags of fertiliser and seed were distributed?
A: 24,675 bags of organic and chemical fertilisers and 5,170 bags of agricultural seed varieties.

Q: Can Hatta residents take part for free?
A: Yes. Registration was open to Hatta residents free of charge, and participants were exempt from permit fees for temporary food-related activities during the event.

Q: Is entry open to the public?
A: Yes, the festival offered free access to the public.

Q: What was new about the third edition?
A: Government and private-sector participation to support People of Determination was included comprehensively for the first time, and the festival grew in scale and participation.

Part 5 - Fifth season of the Farmers' Market

Source: Dubai Municipality, 'Fifth season of the Farmers' Market launches at Quranic Park'

URL: https://www.dm.gov.ae/fifth-season-of-the-farmers-market-launches-at-quranic-park/

Published / updated: 5 December 2025

Retrieved: 7 Oct 2026

Note: The u.ae programme page lists seasonal farmers' market events as part of Dubai Farms. This press release itself does not use the name 'Dubai Farms'; it describes the market as a Dubai Municipality initiative supporting Emirati farmers.

Summary

The fifth season of the Farmers' Market opened on Saturday 6 December 2025 at Quranic Park in Al Khawaneej. It is a Dubai Municipality community initiative that supports Emirati farmers and promotes sustainable agriculture by letting farmers sell their products directly to residents and visitors.

Dates and times

Season	Fifth season
Venue	Quranic Park, Al Khawaneej, Dubai
Dates	Every Saturday and Sunday from 6 December 2025 to 8 February 2026
Hours	4:30 PM to 9:00 PM
Farmers	41 Emirati farmers, including 16 vendors specialising in agricultural products and supplies
Food and drink	Eight restaurants and cafes
Previous season	The fourth season drew 102,625 visitors, who bought vegetables, fruits, dairy products, honey and dates

Attractions

New for the fifth season: a Farm Play Area, a stamp-collection platform, a Fruit Scents Corner, the Tree of Wisdom experience, a Plant Lab, a Petting Zoo and an opening-day drone show. The programme also includes educational activities on sustainable farming, healthy nutrition and recycling, and interactive workshops for children and families. Visitors can also use advisory services for farmers, training courses and agricultural guidance.

Support Dubai Municipality gives farmers

The Municipality provides integrated support through logistical services, agricultural supplies, awareness workshops, guidance sessions, training programmes and consultations. These promote sustainable farming and raise productivity. Mohammed Abdulrahman Ahli, Acting Director of the Public Parks and Recreational Facilities Department, said the market opens

direct marketing channels for small agricultural businesses and encourages the community to buy local products.

Questions and answers

Q: Where is the Farmers' Market held?
A: At Quranic Park in Al Khawaneej, Dubai.

Q: When does the fifth season run, and what are the opening hours?
A: Every Saturday and Sunday from 6 December 2025 to 8 February 2026, from 4:30 PM to 9:00 PM.

Q: How many farmers take part?
A: 41 Emirati farmers, including 16 vendors specialising in agricultural products and supplies.

Q: How popular was the previous season?
A: The fourth season attracted 102,625 visitors.

Q: What products are sold?
A: Fresh local produce; the fourth season's sales included vegetables, fruits, dairy products, honey and dates.

Q: What is new in the fifth season?
A: A Farm Play Area, stamp-collection platform, Fruit Scents Corner, Tree of Wisdom experience, Plant Lab, Petting Zoo and an opening-day drone show.

Part 6 - Timeline and consolidated facts

Timeline

4 Mar 2024	Sheikh Hamdan announces the Dubai Farms programme, run by Dubai Municipality.
2024	Dubai Municipality gives Hatta farmers 24,550 bags of fertilisers, 2,440 bags of seeds and 1,350 light and pheromone traps, and holds over 1,250 field visits, 12 training courses and four forums.
18-22 Jan 2025	Second Hatta Farming Festival at Leem Lake, Hatta, with 25 Emirati farmers, homesteaders and agricultural companies.
30 Dec 2024	Last update date shown on the u.ae Dubai Farms programme page.
6 Dec 2025 - 8 Feb 2026	Fifth season of the Farmers' Market at Quranic Park, with 41 Emirati farmers.
Until 1 Feb 2026	Third Hatta Farming Festival at Hatta Leem Lake, announced 27-28 January 2026, with AED 3.7 million of Hatta support packages.

Services by theme

Advice and training: farming consultation services; agricultural extension; field visits; training courses; agricultural forums; awareness workshops and guidance sessions.

Supplies and prices: subsidised farming supplies; fertiliser and seed distribution; competitive prices for supplies, machinery and irrigation systems.

Testing and health: required lab testing; Dubai Smart Mobile Laboratory (vegetables, fruits, groundwater, irrigation); Dubai Central Laboratory and veterinary services; Brucella antibody detection; pest control, including light and pheromone traps.

Markets and sales: guidance toward local market needs; contracting with a specialised crop distributor; seasonal farmers' markets; Hatta Farming Festival marketplaces.

Community and agri-tourism: Plant Your Food (house gardening); Hatta Farming Festival; Strawberry Model Farm in Hatta; tourism and production projects.

People and organisations named in the sources

Sheikh Hamdan bin Mohammed bin Rashid Al Maktoum	Crown Prince of Dubai; Chairman of the Executive Council; launched Dubai Farms. Later releases also give him the titles Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE, and Chairman of the Higher Committee for Development and Citizens Affairs.
Sheikh Mohammed bin Rashid Al Maktoum	Vice President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai; launched Dubai Social Agenda 33.
Dubai Municipality	The government body that runs the programme and its events.

Marwan bin Ghalita	Acting Director General of Dubai Municipality in January 2025; Director General in January 2026 (as titled in the sources).
Dr. Amna bint Abdullah Al Dhahak	UAE Minister of Climate Change and Environment (as titled in January 2025).
Mohammed Abdulrahman Ahli	Acting Director of the Public Parks and Recreational Facilities Department, Dubai Municipality.
Brand Dubai	Creative arm of the Government of Dubai Media Office; launched the Hatta Winter initiative.
Supreme Committee to Oversee the Development of Hatta	Committee under whose supervision the Hatta Farming Festival is organised.

Part 7 - Coverage notes and gaps

Sources used

- u.ae - The Dubai Farms programme (page updated 30 Dec 2024).
- ARN News Centre - launch article (5 March 2024), which quotes Sheikh Hamdan's announcement.
- Dubai Municipality - second Hatta Farming Festival release (18 January 2025).
- Dubai Municipality - third Hatta Farming Festival release (27-28 January 2026).
- Dubai Municipality - fifth Farmers' Market season release (5 December 2025).

What could not be retrieved

- The WAM (Emirates News Agency) launch article linked from the u.ae page loaded only a page shell, so it is not summarised here.
- A search for pages on the Plant Your Food initiative did not finish in time, so this document has no detail beyond the one-line description on u.ae.

Information not found in these sources

A chatbot built on this document should not guess at the items below. Point users to Dubai Municipality (dm.gov.ae) or the u.ae portal for them:

- Eligibility rules beyond 'Emirati farmers who own productive agricultural projects'.
- How to apply or register for the programme, required documents, and fees.
- Subsidy amounts, percentages or price lists for supplies, machinery and irrigation systems.
- The name of the specialised crop distributor.
- Contact numbers, email addresses or service-centre locations for Dubai Farms.
- Details of the first Hatta Farming Festival, and results of the second and third editions (visitor numbers).
- Event dates after the ones listed in the timeline.

Source reliability and dates

The u.ae page and the Dubai Municipality releases are official government sources. The ARN News Centre article is a news report that reproduces Sheikh Hamdan's announcement. Figures such as bags of fertiliser or visitor counts are those given in each release on its date; later releases may update them. This document was compiled on 7 October 2026 and does not reflect changes after that date.